

INTERNATIONAL news

WT Microelectronics acquires Future Electronics for \$3.8B

Taiwan-based firm WT Microelectronics has acquired Pointe-Claire-based Future Electronics for \$3.8 billion. Future has been in the news for its troubled history involving allegations against its founder, Robert Miller, and his alleged illegal activities with minors. WT Microelectronics reported that Future Electronics generated significant financial results during the first half of 2023, with revenues of \$2.9 billion, operating income of \$228 million, and net income of \$184 million. Miller stepped down as CEO to address his legal issues and health concerns, and Omar Baig assumed corporate responsibilities.

Inventec, Renesas partner to develop PoC for automotive gateways

Inventec and Renesas Electronics Corporation have partnered to develop a proof-of-concept (PoC) for automotive gateways, focusing on tier-1 automotive suppliers and OEMs, to drive inno-



vation in vehicle development for the rapidly growing EV market, leveraging Renesas's R-Car system-on-chip (SoC) technology. The first PoC will be available from Inventec in Q2 of 2024. The new PoC will drive innovation in vehicle development and create new possibilities for emerging vehicle manufacturers worldwide to participate in the rapidly expanding EV market.

Intel partners with Tower after failed acquisition attempt

Tower Semiconductor and Intel have partnered after the latter failed to acquire Tower for \$5 billion. As part of the new terms of the partnership, Tower Semiconductor will invest \$300 million in equipment at Intel's New Mexico campus, a move made possible by an earlier \$353 million break fee paid by Intel to Tower when the merger fell through. The latest development allows Intel to benefit from Tower's business without the regulatory hurdles, while also utilising the funds previously allocated for the merger.

Indie Semiconductor acquires EXALOS for \$45 million

Autotech solutions innovator Indie Semiconductor has acquired EXALOS AG, a Swiss photonics company. Indie paid approximately \$45 million to EXALOS equity holders in a combination of cash and Indie Class A common shares. There is an opportunity for additional payouts of up to \$20 million if certain revenue-based performance targets are met. The acquisition has been approved by the boards of directors of both Indie and EXALOS. Financially, the acquisition is expected to be neutral in 2023 and accretive to Indie's results in 2024.

China to invest \$41B in domestic chip industry

China is set to invest \$41 billion (300 billion yuan) in its semiconductor sector, making it the third largest fund infusion till now in the sector. China's target of 300 billion yuan (\$41 billion) outdoes similar funds in 2014 and 2019, which, according to government reports, raised 138.7 billion yuan and 200 billion yuan, respectively. Out of the proposed 300 billion yuan, China's finance ministry is set to contribute 60 billion yuan to the investment.

Apple extends Arm partnership beyond 2040 amid Arm's IPO plans

Apple Inc. has extended its partnership with semiconductor and software company Arm for over two decades, beyond 2040, reaffirming its commitment to technological advancements and mutual growth in the tech industry. Arm's technology is crucial for Apple's custom chip development for products like iPhones, iPads, and Mac computers. This announcement coincided with Arm's plans to make 95.5 million American depository shares available to the public through a \$52 billion

TATA Group to invest ₹2 billion in chip test and packaging facility in Kolar

Tata Group plans to invest ₹2 billion in a semiconductor testing and packaging unit in Karnataka, specifically in Narasapura, Kolar district, located approximately 65km from Bengaluru, as part of its expansion in the semiconductor industry. With Tata Group taking over Wistron's iPhone manufacturing unit in Kolar, they are likely to set up an assembly, testing, marking, and packaging (ATMP)

plant in the same region. The Tata investment is part of the 91 industrial investment proposals totalling ₹76.59 billion, cleared by the state-level single window clearance committee (SLSWCC) in Karnataka. The cleared proposals are expected to generate 18,146 jobs within the state.

Foxconn, Vedanta submit separate proposals for chip manufacturing in India

Vedanta and Foxconn have separately submitted different proposals for

chip manufacturing in India to the government, each with their proposed technology partners and details. The government is yet to decide. Foxconn has partnered with STMicroelectronics to build a 40nm chip plant, which will reportedly produce chips used in cars, cameras, medical devices, etc.

Assam government to seek investments worth ₹400 billion in chip sector

The Assam government is actively seeking investments of ₹400 bil-